

MAHARASHTRA'S SILICON VALLEY MOMENT: HOW ONE INDIAN STATE IS REWRITING THE FUTURE OF FARMING

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis is deploying artificial intelligence at unprecedented scale to transform agriculture, and in the process, challenging assumptions about technology's role in emerging economies.

When Devendra Fadnavis took office as Maharashtra's Chief Minister in December 2024, he didn't commission studies or form committees. Instead, he launched what might be India's most ambitious experiment in agricultural technology, deploying artificial intelligence to serve 2.7 million farmers, many of whom have never owned a smartphone.

The initiative, unveiled at the recent India AI Impact Summit, represents a fundamental reimagining of how technology can serve rural communities. Unlike Silicon Valley's tendency toward app-first solutions, Maharashtra's approach acknowledges a harder truth: digital inclusion requires meeting people where they are, not where venture capitalists wish they would be.

At the heart of this transformation sits MahaVistaar, an AI ecosystem that Fadnavis describes as "a digital friend to every farmer in Maharashtra." The platform delivers personalized agricultural advisories, pest intelligence, weather forecasts, and market information tailored to individual plots. But it's true innovation lies not in what it does, but in how it reaches its users.



"We are not interested in isolated pilots that gather dust in reports. We are driving institutional transformation at scale."

Devendra Fadnavis, Chief Minister